Be Careful of the One You Put to Flight

John P. Kennon
Manuscript excerpt

Be Careful of the One You Put to Flight

Bro. John Kennon 18JUN25

"How should one chase a thousand, and two put ten thousand to flight, except their Rock had sold them, and the LORD had shut them up?"
— Deuteronomy 32:30 (KJV)

Let’s unpack this like a spiritual grenade, because there’s both divine encouragement and judgment wrapped in this verse.

The Song of Moses (Deuteronomy 32)

This verse is part of "The Song of Moses," a poetic prophecy God gave Moses just before his death. It’s not a worship song—it’s a legal testimony, a divine indictment against Israel’s future rebellion. God tells Moses that after his death, the people will corrupt themselves, turn to idols, and forget the God who delivered them.

Deuteronomy 32 lays out:

God’s faithfulness vs. Israel’s unfaithfulness

Warnings of judgment for idolatry

A call to remember the Rock (God) who birthed and protected them

The consequences of abandoning Him

So verse 30 is not a motivational poster moment—it’s actually a sobering observation of defeat.

Meaning of the Verse

"How should one chase a thousand, and two put ten thousand to flight, except their Rock had sold them…"

This verse flips the normal expectation of victory on its head. Ordinarily, Israel—when faithful—would be the ones causing their enemies to flee.

But here? It’s Israel being routed, overwhelmed, and outmatched.

Key Phrases:

"One chase a thousand…" – This is an unnatural military result. One person shouldn’t be able to rout an entire army—unless God is involved.

"Except their Rock had sold them…" – This is a Hebrew idiom implying divine withdrawal or judgment. God allowed their enemies to overtake them because of Israel's disobedience.

So the verse is a rhetorical question, dripping with grief: "How could this happen—unless the Lord Himself allowed it?"

Backstory and Implications

When Israel followed God, He fought for them. Think Jericho. Gideon. David vs. Goliath.

When they turned to idols, God removed His protective hand.

This verse stands as both a reminder of supernatural victory when God fights for you, and a warning of supernatural defeat when you abandon Him.

The Turnaround: Why We Still Quote It with Victory Today

You might hear this verse preached as a declaration of spiritual authority—“One puts a thousand to flight! Two, ten thousand!”—and that’s not wrong when taken in faith.

But for that to be true, the condition must be met: “If the Lord is with you.” It’s a covenantal promise, not just a poetic boast.

“Hell trembles not at your number, but at your covenant. When God is with you, your impact multiplies. One can rout a thousand demonic assignments—but when two stand in unity, aligned with the Rock, they put ten thousand to flight. Not because of their strength, but because of who fights for them!”

This verse is a mirror—showing us what happens with God and without Him.
So choose your Rock wisely. Stand on Him—and watch what one (or two) can do.

We love to shout this verse in victory — about unity, synergy, and divine multiplication. But the principle cuts both ways. What if the person you influenced, chased, or cast out… doesn’t flee alone? What if what you put to flight becomes ten thousand strong?

Today, we look at the legacy of influence — the unintended consequences of leadership, compromise, and legacy. And no story paints this picture more vividly than the lineage of the kings of Israel — from David to Solomon and beyond.

I. The Influence of David — A Moment that Multiplied

David was God's anointed. A man after His own heart. But one evening, he looked, desired, and fell. Bathsheba. Adultery. Murder. Cover-up.

From that sin came Solomon — the wisest man to ever live. But wisdom alone doesn't guarantee obedience.

Solomon asked for wisdom — and God granted it.

He built God’s house — and God filled it.

But he also married 700 wives and kept 300 concubines.